

2.5.1 Title, researchers and institution

קול קורא 34/2026 · משרד האנרגיה והתשתיות · יחידת המדען הראשי · מסלול אקדמיה

JouleFlex: A Model-Based Decision and Control Framework for Maximizing Useful AI Work under Dynamic Power Limits

JouleFlex: מודלים ובקרה חכמה למקסום תפוקת AI תחת מגבלות הספק משתנות

Principal Investigator (מנהל הפרויקט): Alexander Apartsin, Senior Lecturer, Department of Computer Science · **Institution:** Holon Institute of Technology (HIT)

2.5.2 Abstract / תקציר

English (300/300 words)

In July 2026 Israel's Electricity Authority froze new data-center connection requests after the queue reached 27,000 megawatts. Under electricity limits, data centers switch GPUs (AI processors) off or cap their power, deciding in watts (the momentary draw), not joules (the energy consumed). A capped GPU computes slower and pays its fixed power floor longer, so energy per unit of useful work can rise even as the meter shows fewer watts: less AI per kilowatt-hour. A similar challenge exists in aviation, where it is solved: fuel flow rises far faster than speed, yet slow flight burns fuel longer, so airlines cruise at the speed minimizing fuel per kilometer.

The PI's recent study measured the time-power tradeoff for AI workloads (5,500 measurements, 20 models, four GPUs). Energy per task is U-shaped in the power cap. On the large GPUs its minimum, the Joule Point (JP), sits at 43 to 46 percent of rated power; holding a card there cut energy per task 29 to 31 percent while running 1.2 times slower. Even under a strict deadline, capping saved 28 percent of energy while keeping 95 percent of workload value. A fleet simulation on the measured curves (only scheduling simulated) served equal work with 18 to 45 percent less energy.

These insights reshape how AI data centers are planned, managed, and priced, raising decisions no current tool supports: how to design a flexible-connection-ready fleet whose cards run near their JP; how to measure and predict the JP for new cards and jobs; and how to price service to motivate customers toward efficiency, not per-hour billing rewarding the energy-worst point. Each is a modeling problem. This project delivers the decision-support toolkit answering all three, released with an open measurement dataset. Run near its JP, a fleet frees dispatchable power headroom for Israel's flexible-connection scheme.

עברית (300/300 מילים)

ביולי 2026 הקפיאה רשות החשמל בקשות חיבור חדשות של מרכזי נתונים לאחר שהתור הגיע ל-27,000 מגה-ואט. כאשר אספקת החשמל מוגבלת, מרכזי נתונים מכבים מעבדי GPU (מעבדי בינה מלאכותית) או קובעים להם תקרת הספק; ההחלטות מתקבלות בוואטים, ההספק הרגעי, ולא בג'ולים, האנרגיה הנצרכת. מעבד GPU תחת תקרת הספק מחשב לאט יותר וצורך את הספק הבסיס הקבוע שלו זמן ממושך יותר; לכן האנרגיה ליחידת חישוב מועיל עלולה לעלות אף שהמונה מציג פחות ואטים: פחות בינה מלאכותית לכל קילוואט-שעה. אתגר דומה קיים בתעופה, ושם הוא נפתר: קצב צריכת הדלק עולה מהר בהרבה מן המהירות, אך טיסה איטית שורפת דלק זמן רב יותר; לכן חברות התעופה משייטות במהירות הממוצעת את צריכת הדלק לקילומטר.

מחקר שערך לאחרונה החוקר הראשי מדד את יחסי הגומלין בין זמן להספק בעומסי בינה מלאכותית (5,500 מדידות, 20 מודלים, ארבעה מעבדי GPU). האנרגיה למשימה מתארת עקומת U כתלות בתקרת ההספק. בכרטיסים הגדולים נקודת המינימום שלה, נקודת הג'ול (Joule Point; JP), מצויה ב-43 עד 46 אחוזים מההספק הנקוב; החזקת כרטיס בנקודה זו הפחיתה את האנרגיה למשימה ב-29 עד 31 אחוזים בעוד זמן הריצה התארך פי 1.2. אף תחת מועד קשיח, הגבלת ההספק חסכה 28 אחוזים מהאנרגיה תוך שמירת 95 אחוזים מערך העבודה. סימולציית צי על העקומות שנמדדו (רק התזמון מדומה) סיפקה כמות עבודה שווה בצריכת אנרגיה נמוכה ב-18 עד 45 אחוזים.

תובנות אלה משנות את האופן שבו מתוכננים, מנוהלים ומתומחרים מרכזי נתונים לבינה מלאכותית, ומעלות החלטות שאף כלי קיים אינו תומך בהן: כיצד לתכנן צי מוכן-לחיבור-גמיש שכרטיסיו פועלים סמוך ל-JP; כיצד למדוד ולחזות את ה-JP עבור עבודות וכרטיסים חדשים; וכיצד לתמחר את השירות באופן המתמרץ לקוחות להתייעל, במקום החיוב השעתי המתגמל את נקודת ההפעלה הגרועה ביותר אנרגטית. כל אחת מהן היא בעיית מידול. הפרויקט יספק את ערכת התמיכה בהחלטות העונה על שלושתן, שתשוחרר עם מסד מדידות פתוח. צי הפועל סמוך ל-JP משחרר עתודת הספק זמינה לניצול עבור הסדר החיבור הגמיש של ישראל.

2.5.3 Glossary

Term	Meaning
Power	How fast electricity is drawn at a given moment; watts (W) or megawatts (MW). The grid connection is sized by peak power.
Energy	The total electricity consumed: power × time; joules or kilowatt-hours. The bill and the carbon footprint are set by energy.
Power cap	A software limit on a GPU's power draw. Set with one command; takes effect in ~0.2 seconds. The control knob of this project.
TDP	A GPU's full rated power. Running at TDP is today's default.
Joule Point (JP)	The power cap at which energy per task is lowest for a given card; measured at 43–46% of TDP on large GPUs.
Operating point	The pair (GPU, power cap) a job runs at.

Power envelope	A limit on a facility's total power draw that can change over time, set by a budget, a price or carbon signal, or a grid instruction.
Power shaping	Keeping a fleet inside a power envelope by capping jobs, like traffic shaping in networks.
ELF	Our released dataset: dense power-cap sweeps of 20 AI models on 4 GPUs, ~5,500 measured rows.
SLO	Service level objective: the deadline or latency a job must meet.
Firm / flexible capacity	Grid connection capacity guaranteed at all times, versus capacity given on condition that the facility reduces power when instructed.
Card multiplier	The extra cards needed to keep total throughput when capping. It equals the latency ratio (~1.2×).

2.5.4 Objectives of the program

2.5.4.1 The objective

The objective is to construct **JouleFlex**: a toolkit of models, software tools and a simulator for the energy management of GPU-rich AI data centers, built on the JP concept, in three layers. **Models**: the power-response law validated on current hardware and whole servers; a job model calibrating the energy-optimal cap per workload; a transfer model for unmeasured GPUs; and a joint job-and-cap assignment method. **Tools**: a characterization kit qualifying a new GPU within the validated hardware domain in hours, and a fleet control engine holding a facility inside its power envelope while meeting deadlines. **Simulation**: a digital twin replaying measured curves, evaluating any policy or connection scenario before deployment. All layers are released openly with the calibrating corpus (ELF-2, the extended measurement dataset), serving two users: the operator who runs it, and the Ministry that plans, regulates and sizes connections with its numbers. The twin answers the fleet-design question directly: how many cards, of which type, run near the JP behind a given connection.

2.5.4.2 The research question

Can AI data centers operate as controllable electrical loads, each GPU near its energy-optimal cap and the facility inside a changing power limit, so that energy per unit of AI work falls and the power capacity required to serve it shrinks, while admitted work keeps its service promises, under Israeli grid constraints?

Six sub-questions structure the work plan:

1. **Does the law generalize?** The power law and JP were measured on 20 models and 4 GPUs; do they hold on H100-class and, as access allows, B200-class hardware, production serving software, and shared GPUs?
2. **When is one cap per card enough?** The measured JP was nearly constant per card in the loaded regime; the project maps where that constant breaks and fits a job model there.
3. **Where is the true optimum at the wall?** Board-power measurements miss host overhead, and the grid connection is sized at the wall: what is the JP of the whole node, and of the facility?
4. **Can we skip the measurement?** Can an unmeasured GPU's JP be predicted from published electrical characteristics plus at most one short test, characterizing a new card model in hours?

5. **Can allocation and power be optimized together, in motion?** Choose at once which job runs on which card and at what cap, maximizing served work under a time-varying power limit (price, carbon, grid instruction) with every deadline met; the measured result covers fixed caps and a fixed placement rule; the joint problem is open.
6. **How much flexibility can a facility sell, and who has the incentive?** How much power can be shed on instruction, how fast, for how long, at what service cost, the numbers behind conditional connections; and which pricing rules make offering flexibility profitable, when per-hour billing rewards the energy-worst point?

2.5.5 The proposed research

2.5.5.1 Scientific and technological background

The general problem. AI data centers are the world's fastest-growing electricity consumers, with demand projected to approach 945 TWh by 2030 [3].

The Israeli challenge is specific and pressing. Israel's grid is an isolated island system with no cross-border interconnections, so new demand must be met from domestic capacity; in July 2026 the Electricity Authority halted new data-center connection requests for 140 days, after the queue reached about 27,000 MW, roughly three times average national consumption [2]. The binding limit is grid capacity in megawatts: the national need is more AI work from every connected megawatt.

Today's operating decisions think in watts, not joules. Under electrical stress a data center either switches GPUs off, discarding service, or caps GPU power energy-blind: a capped GPU computes slower, paying its fixed power floor for more seconds, so capping too deep lowers the dashboard watts while raising the joules on the bill. Unconstrained, the default is full rated power, where the last speed carries a steep power surcharge. A further choice goes unweighed: for a fixed workload, whether to concentrate it on fewer cards at full power or spread it across more cards at partial power; our measurements show the second is sometimes more energy-efficient.

Our discovery. The applicant's study [1] mapped, over 20 AI models and four GPU types (~5,500 instrumented measurements, released as the ELF dataset), how energy per task depends on the power cap: board power follows a simple physical law in the computing rate θ ,

$$P(\theta) = P_0 + a \theta^\beta, \quad \text{median } R^2 = 0.99,$$

a fixed floor P_0 plus a superlinear term. Energy per task, $E = P/\theta$, is therefore U-shaped in the cap; its minimum, the **JP**, sits at 43 to 46 percent of rated power on the large GPUs, cutting

energy per task by 29 to 31 percent at an exactly priced cost: tasks run about 1.2 times slower, and holding throughput takes that factor more cards. The cap is one software command, settling in about 0.2 seconds, fast enough to follow grid signals; behind a fixed feed the measured A100 case yields about 50 percent more AI tasks per megawatt [1].

2.5.5.2 Review of existing knowledge

Four research lines meet here. *Energy-proportional computing* [4] identified the fixed, work-independent part of server power as the central inefficiency; our floor P_0 measures it for modern GPUs, and the JP is where paying it stops being worthwhile. *Speed-scaling theory* proved that energy is minimized at a sub-maximal speed [5,6,7]; the ELF dataset gives the measured form for GPU inference, where the law holds per operating point and breaks when pooled across batch sizes. *GPU energy systems*, notably Zeus [8] and the ML.ENERGY benchmarks [9,10], search for a good setting per job at runtime; the per-card-constant JP replaces that search with a one-time characterization. *Production context*: cluster studies [11] and public traces [12] supply realistic job arrivals; energy-aware GPU schedulers [13,14] leave each device's power draw at its default; methodology reviews [15] motivate our fixed protocol. Among the cited literature we found no system that keeps an AI fleet inside a time-varying, grid-facing envelope with auditable compliance, or that quantifies AI facilities as providers of firm and flexible capacity.

2.5.5.3 Knowledge gaps

- **The law's reach is unmapped.** The law and JP are established for single jobs at fixed settings on three inference GPUs; their persistence on H100-class and, as access allows, B200-class hardware, production serving software and shared cards is unknown, and placing the JP on a new GPU still requires a full sweep, since prediction from published characteristics is the study's stated next step [1].
- **The job-dependence structure is unmapped.** The per-card constant holds in the measured loaded regime; outside it the optimum moves, and no model predicts a job's operating point from its features.
- **All published numbers are board numbers.** Energy studies measure board power, but the grid meters the wall; host overhead (CPU, memory, cooling, power-supply losses) shifts the true optimum upward by an unmeasured amount; until it is placed at node level, no megawatt claim is grounded.
- **Allocation and power control are not optimized together in the cited work.** The measured 18–45 percent fleet saving used a fixed budget, a fixed placement rule and caps chosen afterwards; the joint problem, assigning jobs and setting every cap at once under hourly-changing limits, couples discrete scheduling to continuous control through the shared power budget and is unformulated.

- **Flexibility is unquantified.** How much power an AI facility can shed, how fast, for how long, at what cost has never been measured or standardized; Israel's regulator is rationing connections without the numbers to credit flexible ones.
- **The incentive problem is identified but unsolved.** Per-hour billing makes the renter's cheapest choice the energy-worst point, and a per-joule surcharge is too weak to fix it [1]; which structural instruments work is open.

2.5.5.4 Description of the proposed research

JouleFlex builds one measured foundation and three tools on it: first work out the energy-optimal way to run each job on each card, then control power to achieve it. **WP1 and WP2 measure and predict:** they extend the dataset to current hardware, production software, and whole-server power, then turn those measurements into models that place any card's or job's efficient point without a full sweep. **WP3 controls:** a real-time engine that decides which job runs on which card and at what power cap, tested in a digital twin before any deployment. **WP4 and WP5 connect to the grid:** they define and measure the flexibility a controlled facility can offer, and study the pricing and connection rules that make efficient operation worthwhile. Everything is released openly.

2.5.5.5 Methods (work packages)

WP	Objective	Approach and output
WP1	Extend the energy-versus-power measurements to current GPUs, production software, and whole-server power.	Re-run the study's measurement sweep on new GPUs (H100/L40S class) and production serving engines (vLLM [16], TensorRT-LLM), reading power at three rented tiers: the GPU board (NVML), the node (RAPL), and the server's power-supply input (BMC, read out-of-band via IPMI/Redfish). Accuracy is taken from vendor specifications and cross-checked across tiers. <i>Output:</i> the ELF-2 open dataset (board and server-input).
WP2	Predict any new card's or job's efficient operating point without a full measurement sweep.	A job model predicts a job's best power cap from its features; a transfer model predicts a new card's curve from its published specifications plus one short test. Both report error bars and a stated range of validity, and a short proof bounds the small penalty of using one cap per card. <i>Output:</i> the characterization kit (models and one-test protocol).
WP3	Decide, in real time, which job runs on which card and at what power cap, to do the most useful work within a changing power limit.	A controller that makes both choices together, since moving a job changes the power left for the others, tested in a digital twin that replays the measured curves against exact baselines. When power is too tight it defers or rejects low-priority work and reports the cost. The joint problem is NP-hard; the per-card capping step is solved exactly. <i>Output:</i> the open control engine and digital twin.
WP4	Define what flexibility a controlled facility can offer	Specify the contractable quantities, a committed power envelope, a flexibility offer, and an auditable delivery record, with ramp and

	the grid, and measure it.	recovery metrics; demonstrate them on a rented metered server and at fleet scale in the twin, under an Israeli firm-plus-flexible scenario. <i>Output:</i> the flexibility products and the Israel demonstration.
WP5	Find pricing and connection rules that reward efficient operation, and release everything openly.	An incentive model showing why per-hour billing rewards the energy-worst point and what changes fix it; a valuation of the flexible-connection option from public Noga and Electricity Authority data; each rule tested in the WP3 twin. <i>Output:</i> the policy report and the open release of the dataset, control engine, twin, and interfaces.

Success metrics are set in advance: law fit and JP location per card and engine; transfer-model error on held-out cards; energy per served job and deadline compliance versus baselines; envelope violation, ramp and recovery in the demonstration; sensitivity of every economic figure to its price inputs.

2.5.5.6 Novelty and originality

- **AI load as a grid resource.** Sub-second actuation plus deadline-aware control turns an AI facility into a provider of measurable firm and flexible capacity, a category we have not found in practice or literature, immediately relevant to Israel’s connection challenge.
- **From per-job search to one-time measurement, with an exact price.** In the loaded regime, one per-card-model measurement replaces earlier per-job runtime search at under one percent penalty [1], and the extra cards to hold throughput equal the latency ratio, so every recommendation carries its exact capital cost.
- **Energy first, power as the means.** We measured the cost of universal full-power operation (about a third of inference energy) and located the alternative; existing capping satisfies watts while possibly raising joules, whereas JouleFlex sets power to the computed energy optimum per (card, job).
- **From the board to the wall.** Published GPU energy results are board-power results; measuring the node’s JP at server-input power moves the claim toward what the grid actually meters.
- **An open dataset with no equivalent.** To our knowledge no open dataset releases dense power-cap sweeps of energy per inference across many AI models and GPUs at the granularity to locate the energy-optimal point; existing open power-cap sweeps cover training or HPC workloads, and inference energy leaderboards report a single operating point, not a sweep. ELF fills that gap, and the project extends an asset that already exists rather than one it must first build.
- **The joint allocation-and-capping problem.** Assignment and power control were solved separately; coupled through the shared power budget they define a new scheduling-control problem, and the controller is a first measured solution.

2.5.5.7 Fit to the Ministry's R&D goals

The roles divide cleanly: operators run the hardware, the Ministry sets the rules. Just as a regulator sets fuel-economy standards without driving the cars, JouleFlex gives the Ministry the measured basis for connection terms, planning coefficients and efficiency standards, without operating any facility itself. The proposal addresses the Ministry's 2026 R&D policy [17] under call 34/2026 [18], in particular high-priority clauses of Chapter 2:

Clause	How the project addresses it
16.2 · טכנולוגיות תכנון וניהול הספקת אנרגיה לחוות שרתים	The core deliverable: power shaping manages a server farm's energy supply in real time; the flexibility framework tells planners how much a farm needs.
6.2 · טכנולוגיות לניהול אנרגיה מקומי וניהול ביקושים	A facility following a power envelope on instruction, at ~0.2-second actuation, is a demand-response resource of grid-relevant size.
8 · התייעלות באנרגיה וביזור מערכות אנרגיה (priority 2026)	29–31 percent less energy per AI task at the card, 18–45 percent less per served job at the fleet, in software on installed hardware.
16.1 · שימוש בבינה מלאכותית ככלי עזר לפיתוח ומחקר בכל הנושאים לעיל (2026) (priority)	AI compute is the subject, learned models and control the instruments, an energy-system tool the deliverable.
15.3 · פיתוח מתודולוגיה לבניית תחזיות ומודלים ופיתוח כלי עזר בקבלת החלטות	Flexibility products, compliance metrics and the regulator-facing report are decision-support instruments for connection policy.

2.5.5.8 Preliminary results

The preliminary results are the applicant's study *The Joule Point* [1] and its ELF dataset: about 5,500 instrumented measurements over 20 models and four GPUs establish the response law (median $R^2 = 0.99$), locate the JP at 43 to 46 percent of TDP with a 29 to 31 percent energy saving per task at 1.2 times longer runs, show one static cap per card serving all twenty workloads at under one percent mean penalty, and demonstrate an 18 to 45 percent fleet-level saving at equal-or-better deadline compliance in a measured-curve simulation, with about 50 percent more work per megawatt behind a fixed GPU power budget. Cap actuation settles in about 191 milliseconds. Under the per-instance-hour billing model analyzed in [1], the renter's cost optimum is the energy-worst operating point. ELF spans four GPU types; the fine sweeps behind the law and the JP cover three (A100, A10G, L4), with the T4 swept coarsely for coverage, and $R^2 = 0.99$ is the median per fixed-setting sweep while pooled per-card fits across workloads are 0.88 to 0.92 (Fig. A1). The benefit persists under tight service: in the strict-deadline experiment of [1], capping saved 28 percent of energy while keeping 95 percent of workload value. The harness, simulator and analysis pipeline ran end to end; the project scales them out rather than building from zero.

2.5.6 Application: expected benefit and impact

2.5.6.1 What the project delivers, concretely

The project delivers five artifacts: the ELF-2 open dataset, the characterization kit, the control engine, the digital twin, and the grid interfaces and policy report (open data formats for the facility's power-envelope commitment and delivery record, plus a regulator-facing report of measured coefficients and pricing). Appendix Table A1 states what each is and who uses it. Each artifact is released openly on delivery, every release crediting the Ministry's R&D program under call 34/2026 [18].

2.5.6.2 Benefit and impact

For operators: the preliminary results indicate 29–31 percent lower energy per task (measured) and 18–45 percent lower per served job (fleet simulation), through software control on installed hardware.

Training: the project trains one postdoctoral researcher across GPU energy measurement, fleet control and energy-market analysis; the open ELF-2 dataset and twin become teaching material, building Israeli capacity at the AI-energy interface.

For the Israeli grid and regulator: the larger benefit. The binding constraint is connection capacity: about 27,000 MW of pending requests [2] strain planned generation through 2035. The JP converts efficiency into capacity: in the measured A100 case, capping delivered about 50 percent more work per megawatt of GPU power. Power shaping lets facilities accept *conditional* connections: firm plus flexible capacity curtailed on instruction. With flexibility measured, committed and audited (WP4), the regulator gains a third option and the frozen queue stops being all-or-nothing. The measured capacity gain is a GPU-board-level result; as an illustrative upper bound, every 1,000 MW of the queue connected under JP operation could deliver the AI work of up to 1,500 MW uncapped, and a workload that would consume 1 TWh uncapped would avoid about 0.3 TWh, roughly 150,000 tonnes of CO₂ at an assumed grid intensity of 0.5 kg per kilowatt-hour; WP1 and WP4 measure how much of the gain survives at server input and facility level before any connection coefficient is recommended. The regulator-facing report quantifies this option and will be submitted as a formal response to the Authority's open consultation on the flexible-connection track [19], placing measured numbers in the docket while the rules are written; the open release lets any operator or authority adopt or certify the mechanism.

2.5.7 Work plan

2.5.7.1 Stages, deliverables, duration and success metrics

Months	Stage	Deliverable	Success metric
M1–M6	WP1: harness; new-generation and production-engine (vLLM) sweeps; three-tier instrumentation	D1: ELF-2 v1	Law fit $R^2 \geq 0.95$ per sweep or deviation documented; JP located (or absence documented) per platform, board and server-input
M5–M8	WP1: shared GPUs, LLM phases, fine-tuning; sweeps where the constant should break	MS1: regime map	Documented validity domain of the law and the constant; where a job model is required; an M8 technical brief to the chief scientist unit
M7–M12	WP2: job model; transfer model; one-test characterization protocol	MS2: models result	Job-model error versus the constant, per regime; transfer-model placement within 5 percentage points of TDP on held-out cards; protocol cost ≤ 8 hours and $\leq \text{₪}1,500$ per card model
M9–M16	WP3: twin; joint controller under fixed, price, carbon and curtailment envelopes	MS3: controller result	Energy per served job and SLO compliance versus uncapped, static-cap and cap-only baselines; a pre-registered floor of at least 10 percent below cap-only energy per served job at equal compliance in one or more envelopes; marginal value of joint assignment; zero exceedance beyond the WP1 noise band (defined in D1) in committed windows, overshoot magnitude and duration reported; transient violations within the band in fewer than 1 percent of control-interval epochs
M14–M20	WP4: flexibility products and metrics; demonstration on rented BMC-metered servers; Israel scenario	MS4: flexibility demonstration	Sheddable power as a fraction of the committed envelope (pre-registered floor: at least 15 percent within the ramp deadline at bounded SLO loss), measured on a BMC-metered server, projected to fleet scale in the twin; ramp within 60 seconds, recovery within 5 minutes; delivery-record compliance and curtailment service cost
M16–M21	WP5: incentive model; connection valuation on published Israeli data; twin evaluation	MS5: policy report draft	Alignment condition per billing structure, confirmed in the twin; option value per MW and break-even curtailment frequency, with sensitivity to every price input
M21–M24	WP5: release, documentation, validation, publication	D2: open release; D3: final report	Public repositories with reproducing pipelines; metered validation; final scientific and policy reports

Two interim briefings to the chief scientist unit are named deliverables: an M8 technical brief and the M21 policy report draft before publication, in Hebrew, circulable to the Authority and

Noga while the flexible-connection track [19] is under design. Every milestone is an inspectable artifact tested against pre-stated criteria; a bounding result is itself a deliverable. Minimum-success path: H100/L40S-class validation, one production serving engine, server-input BMC measurement, the job and transfer models, the joint controller, and one Israeli flexibility scenario; B200-class cards, a second engine, fine-tuning, shared-GPU regimes and the formal approximation guarantee are extension objectives pursued as access and time allow.

2.5.7.2 Budget by stage

Stage	Share	Amount (₪)	Principal costs
M1–M8 (WP1; WP2 begins)	30%	148,314	Postdoctoral researcher; GPU rentals for cap sweeps
M9–M16 (WP2 ends; WP3; WP4 begins)	33%	163,145	Postdoctoral researcher; card-model rentals for transfer validation; twin and controller work
M17–M21 (WP4 ends; WP5)	25%	123,595	Postdoctoral researcher; BMC-metered rentals; flexibility campaign
M22–M24 (WP5: release and validation)	12%	59,326	Postdoctoral researcher; metered validation runs; documentation; dissemination and publication
Total		494,380	Full itemization in the מפרט תקציבי

2.5.7.3 Risks and mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Production serving software (continuous batching, shifting phases) blurs the per-card constant	Static cap loses near-optimality for LLMs	Measured first (WP1, M1); the job model predicts the optimum where the constant breaks
Power-cap control unavailable on some rented platforms	Measurement campaign narrowed	AWS EC2 gives passthrough and root; too-high cap floors are exposed via the graphics clock (L4 [1]); BMC rentals cover the wall tier
No operational grid data beyond public sources	Demonstration less site-specific	The Israel scenario runs entirely on public Noga and Electricity Authority data and needs no external partner
The split incentive blocks adoption	Impact confined to first-party operators	WP5 targets the incentive structure; first-party operators and regulated connections adopt first

2.5.8 The applicant

Project manager and principal investigator: Alexander Apartsin, Senior Lecturer, Computer Science, HIT; single-PI, responsible for all five work packages.

Fit of expertise to the proposed work. The scientific foundation is the PI's own study [1]: the ELF dataset, the law, the JP, the cost identity, the fleet saving. The work plan maps onto that record: power sweeps (WP1); response models with quantified uncertainty (WP2); simulators and schedulers against measured ground truth (WP3, WP4); techno-economic analysis with its incentive analysis already in [1] (WP5). The harness, models and simulation the work scales are built and validated; open release enables independent scrutiny. The project has no external partners; the Israel scenario runs on public Noga and Electricity Authority data. **Research personnel.** One postdoctoral researcher at 90% position, both years, carries the measurement, modeling and control work under the PI's supervision, reported within a month of signature (2.5\$ נספח ט'י).

Resources available to the applicant. The project owns no hardware: board sweeps run on AWS EC2 with root access, the RAPL tier on AWS bare metal, and the wall tier and WP4 demonstration on hourly dedicated servers with BMC PSU telemetry. HIT provides laboratory space, computing and grant administration; the project buys no measurement hardware.

2.5.9 Funding

No other funding exists or is applied for; per 1.5.2\$ נספח ט'י and \$2.10, no complementary funding will be received from any other body and no student receives parallel state funding.

2.5.10 Bibliography

1. Apartsin, A. and Aperstein, Y. (2026). *The Joule Point: an Energy-Optimal Operating Point for AI Inference*. Preprint, September 2026. DOI: [10.13140/RG.2.2.20385.36964](https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.20385.36964) (CC BY 4.0), with the released ELF dataset.
2. JNS (22 July 2026). *Israel halts new data-center grid requests for 140 days amid surge in demand*. Press report on the Electricity Authority's temporary order: pending applications of approximately 27,000 MW, about three times Israel's average electricity consumption. <https://www.jns.org/news/israel-news/israel-halts-new-data-center-grid-requests-for-140-days-amid-surge-in-demand> (the Authority's order is published on gov.il).
3. International Energy Agency (2025). *Energy and AI: Energy Demand from AI*. <https://www.iea.org/reports/energy-and-ai/energy-demand-from-ai>
4. Barroso, L. A. and Hözl, U. (2007). *The Case for Energy-Proportional Computing*. IEEE Computer 40(12), pp. 33–37.
5. Yao, F., Demers, A., and Shenker, S. (1995). *A Scheduling Model for Reduced CPU Energy*. Proceedings of FOCS 1995, pp. 374–382.
6. Miyoshi, A., Lefurgy, C., Van Hensbergen, E., Rajamony, R., and Rajkumar, R. (2002). *Critical Power Slope: Understanding the Runtime Effects of Frequency Scaling*. Proceedings of ICS 2002, pp. 35–44.
7. Gandhi, A., Harchol-Balter, M., Das, R., and Lefurgy, C. (2009). *Optimal Power Allocation in Server Farms*. Proceedings of ACM SIGMETRICS 2009, pp. 157–168.
8. You, J., Chung, J.-W., and Chowdhury, M. (2022). *Zeus: Understanding and Optimizing GPU Energy Consumption of DNN Training*. arXiv: 2208.06102. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2208.06102>
9. Chung, J.-W., Ma, J. J., Wu, R., et al. (2025). *The ML.ENERGY Benchmark: Toward Automated Inference Energy Measurement and Optimization*. arXiv: 2505.06371. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.06371>
10. Chung, J.-W., Wu, R., Ma, J. J., et al. (2026). *Where Do the Joules Go? Diagnosing Inference Energy Consumption*. arXiv: 2601.22076. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.22076>
11. Hu, Q., Sun, P., Yan, S., Wen, Y., et al. (2021). *Characterization and Prediction of Deep Learning Workloads in Large-Scale GPU Datacenters*. arXiv: 2109.01313. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2109.01313>
12. Alibaba Group (2020). *cluster-trace-gpu-v2020: production GPU cluster traces from Alibaba PAI*. <https://github.com/alibaba/clusterdata>
13. Lipe, E., Karia, N., Espenshade, C., Stein, C., Tantawi, A., and Tardieu, O. (2026). *Energy Efficient Scheduling of AI/ML Workloads on Multi-Instance GPUs with Dynamic Repartitioning*. arXiv: 2606.25082. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.25082>
14. Lu, T. and Reda, S. (2026). *Agentic CPU-GPU Scheduling for Heterogeneous AI Workloads*. arXiv: 2607.22242. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.22242>
15. Rodriguez, C., Degioanni, L., Kamení, L., Vidal, R., et al. (2024). *Evaluating the Energy Consumption of Machine Learning: Systematic Literature Review and Experiments*. arXiv: 2408.15128. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2408.15128>
16. Kwon, W., Li, Z., Zhuang, S., et al. (2023). *Efficient Memory Management for Large Language Model Serving with PagedAttention*. Proceedings of SOSP 2023. arXiv: 2309.06180. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2309.06180>
17. Ministry of Energy and Infrastructure (2026). *2026 מדיניות התמיכה במחקר ופיתוח לשנת 2026*. Chapter 1 clauses 6, 8, 15, 16; Chapter 2 priority list.

18. Ministry of Energy and Infrastructure (2026). קול קורא 34/2026 למימון מחקרים בתחום האנרגיה ומדעי האדמה והים.
19. Calcalist (June 2026). Report on the Electricity Authority's public hearing (שימוע): a dedicated connection track for transmission-grid consumers of 50 MVA and above, including a system-operator right to curtail consumption at peak and payments for holding connection capacity. Under public consultation; cited as regulatory direction, not settled regulation. <https://www.calcalist.co.il/calcalistech/article/rylkxemgx> (the hearing documents are published on gov.il).

Appendix A: Figures (within the 5-page allowance of 2.2§ 1'נספח)

JouleFlex · 34/2026 קורא · Appendix to the research proposal, permitted under 2.2§ 1'נספח (graphs, tables and diagrams, up to 5 A4 pages, outside the 10-page limit). All figures are measured results from the applicant's study [1].

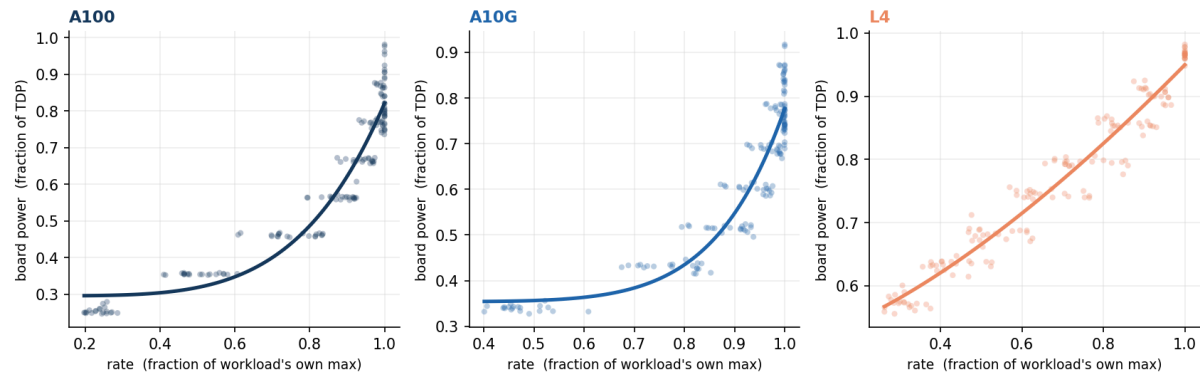


Figure A1. The response law is a card property. One panel per GPU (A100, A10G, L4); each dot is a measured operating point for one of the 20 workloads in the loaded regime, rate normalized to the workload's own maximum and power to the card's TDP. All workloads follow a single fitted law per card, $P(\theta) = P_0 + a \cdot \theta^\beta$ (pooled per-card R^2 of 0.92, 0.88 and higher per-sweep), showing the exponent travels with the card rather than the model. This is the empirical basis for the one-time per-card characterization that WP2 turns into a transfer model.

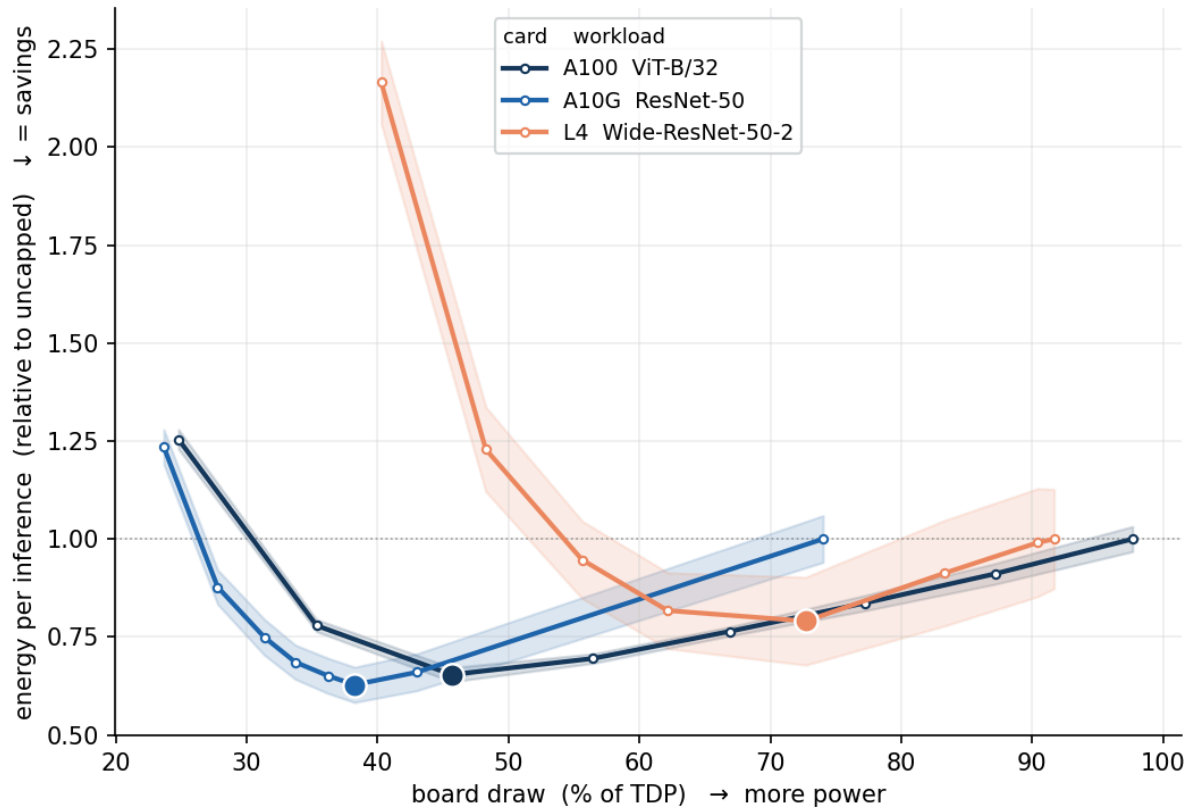


Figure A2. Every card has an energy U-shape. Energy per inference, normalized to each card's own uncapped value, against board draw as a fraction of TDP; the dot marks the JP, the shaded band one standard deviation over repetitions. On the large GPUs the minimum sits at 43–46 percent of TDP and capping to it cuts energy per inference by 29–31 percent; on the L4 the interior minimum lies below the power cap's reachable floor and is exposed by the graphics clock instead, mapping which actuator applies to which card class.

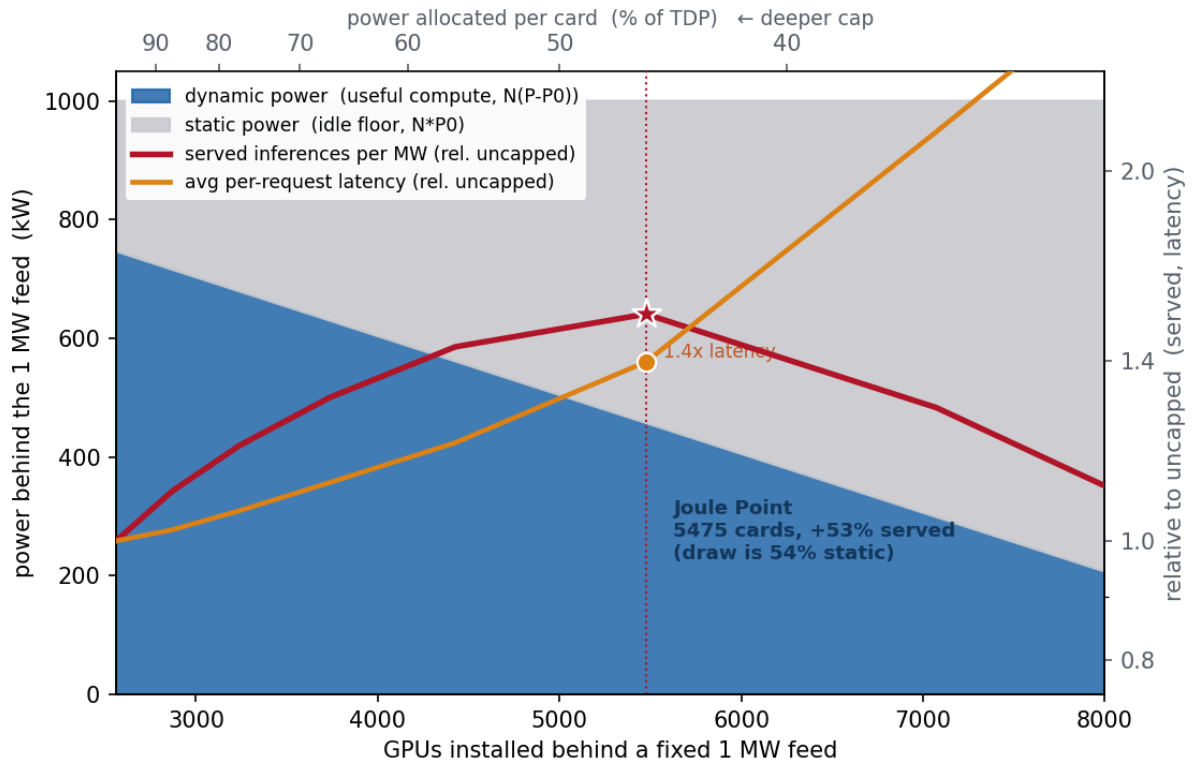


Figure A3. When power, not capital, binds, the JP is the interior optimum. Behind a fixed 1 MW feed (A100, ViT-B/32 at batch 64), installing more GPUs forces each to a deeper cap, shifting the megawatt from useful dynamic compute (blue) to the static idle floor (grey). Served inferences per megawatt (red) peak at the JP, near 5,500 installed cards, about 50 percent above the uncapped configuration. This is the capacity lever the Israel demonstration (WP4) operationalizes: under a rationed connection, efficiency becomes throughput. The same measured curves, allocated exactly across a fleet, dominate uncapped operation at every power budget from 100 down to 40 percent of total TDP; the preliminary measured-curve fleet simulation result appears in section 2.5.5.8.

Table A1. The five deliverables: what each is, who uses it

The project delivers five named artifacts, each with a defined user and use:

Deliverable	What it is	Who uses it, for what
ELF-2	An open dataset: power, throughput and latency at every operating point, board to wall, on current GPUs and production serving software	Researchers and vendors, as ground truth; every other deliverable is built and validated on it
The characterization kit	Software plus protocol: a one-test procedure and the two fitted models placing the JP of a new or unmeasured card within the validated hardware domain, in hours	A GPU engineer or operator qualifying a new card model or a new serving stack before deployment, at known cost
The control engine	An open-source controller engine that assigns jobs and sets caps to keep a fleet inside its envelope, evaluated in the twin and demonstrated on a metered rented server before any deployment	An AI data-center manager, to cut energy per job and honor a committed envelope; its report doubles as the compliance record
The digital twin	A simulator replaying the measured curves of a described fleet and job mix, evaluating any policy or envelope scenario exactly before hardware is touched	An operator testing policies before deployment; a planner or regulator asking what a proposed facility could deliver and shed under a given connection
The grid interface and policy report	A blueprint: open formats for the envelope commitment, the flexibility offer and the delivery record, plus a regulator-facing report quantifying firm-plus-flexible connections against the national queue	The Electricity Authority and Noga, as the technical basis for offering conditional connections and auditing compliance

Table A1. The chain of use is direct: ELF-2 calibrates the models, the models feed the controller, the twin proves the controller before deployment, and the grid interface turns the controlled facility into something the regulator can contract with.
